

Harness, Not Collar

Take the pressure off your dog's throat and ease the cough.

Why It Matters

A collar sits right on the windpipe. For dogs that cough, and especially small breeds with a weak or collapsing trachea, every pull tightens that pressure and can trigger a coughing fit. A harness spreads the pressure across the chest instead, so the airway stays open.

Which Harness to Choose

Type	Best For
Y-front / H-style harness	Keeps all pressure off the throat, best overall
Padded step-in harness	Easy on, comfortable for small or senior dogs
Back-clip harness	Calm walkers, no pulling on the neck

How to Fit It Right

- The chest strap should sit LOW, across the breastbone, never up on the throat
- You should fit two fingers flat under any strap, snug but not tight
- Check that the front leg openings do not rub the armpits
- For toy breeds, pick a lightweight harness so it does not weigh them down

What to Avoid

- Any collar for leash pressure if your dog coughs (use it for ID tags only)
- Choke, prong, or slip collars, especially with a coughing or small dog
- Retractable leads that let your dog hit the end of the line and jolt the chest

A HONKING, GOOSE-LIKE COUGH in a small breed can be a sign of a collapsing trachea. A harness helps with comfort, but it is not a diagnosis. Have a persistent honking cough checked by your vet.